

doc-means-of-grace

Affirms · Soteriology › Means of Grace · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

God ordinarily nourishes faith and sanctifies His people through appointed means: the Word read and preached, prayer, the breaking of bread, baptism, and Spirit-empowered Christian fellowship.

Rationale

Scripture itself names the ordained means by which God conveys grace to his people. Rom 10:17 *ara he pistis ex akoes, he de akoe dia rhematos Christou* (G4102 *pistis*, G189 *akoe*, G4487 *rhema*) names the spoken word of Christ as the instrument through which faith is given. 1 Cor 11:23-26 names the Lord's Supper as the appointed memorial proclamation of Christ's death (G2605 *katagello*) until he comes. Matt 28:19 commands baptizing (G907 *baptizo*) into the triune name as the disciple-making act. Acts 2:42 names the four ordained practices the apostolic church devoted itself to (G4342 *proskartereo*): the apostles' teaching (G1322 *didache*), fellowship (G2842 *koinonia*), the breaking of bread (G2800 *klasis tou artou* G740), and the prayers (G4335 *proseuche*). 1 Tim 4:5 names the word of God and prayer (G3056 *logos theou*, G1783 *enteuxis*) as that which sanctifies (G37 *hagiazō*). Eph 5:26 names the washing of water with the word (G3067 *lutron*, G4487 *rhema*) as the means by which Christ cleanses his church. Luke 11:13 names the Father's giving of the Holy Spirit (G4151 *pneuma hagion*) in answer to asking (G154 *aiteo*). The doctrine that God uses appointed means is pan-canonically demonstrated. The disagreement among Christian lineages is over WHICH means and HOW MANY (two ordinances or seven sacraments), not whether God uses ordained means at all.

Reasoning

The Bible teaches that God ordinarily gives grace to his people through appointed means. The strongest reason for this is the way Scripture itself names these means and ties them to God's saving work. Romans 10:17 says faith comes from hearing, and hearing through the word of Christ. The preached and read word is the appointed means through which God creates faith. 1 Corinthians 11:23 to 26 names the Lord's Supper as a memorial Christ himself instituted, where the church proclaims the Lord's death until he comes. Matthew 28:19 commands baptizing in the triune name as part of making disciples. Acts 2:42 names four practices the apostolic church devoted itself to: the apostles' teaching, fellowship, the breaking of bread, and the prayers. 1 Timothy 4:5 says food is sanctified by the word of God and prayer. Ephesians 5:26 says Christ cleanses his church by the washing of water with the word. Luke 11:13 says the Father gives the Holy Spirit to those who ask him. Across these passages a single pattern emerges. God ordains specific instruments, the word, prayer, baptism, the Lord's Supper, and the gathered fellowship of believers, and uses them to nourish faith and sanctify his people. The strongest complicating texts are those that warn against treating the outward rite as the cause of saving grace. Simon Magus in Acts 8:13 is baptized yet Peter says his heart is not right with God in Acts 8:21. Isaiah 1:11 to 17 and Amos 5:21 record God rejecting the appointed worship of people whose hearts are far from him. These passages do not abolish the means; they show that the means do not operate as mechanical guarantees apart from faith. The verdict handles the tension by holding that God truly uses these means but that he uses them in conjunction with faith, not as substitutes for it. The means are real channels of grace; they are not magical mechanisms that bypass the heart.

Denominational landscape

Christian lineages agree on the general doctrine that God uses ordained means to convey grace and disagree on which means and how many. The patristic church from the earliest period treated baptism and the Eucharist as central means through which the Spirit is given and Christ is received; Justin Martyr in the First Apology and Cyril of Jerusalem in the Catechetical Lectures describe both as effectual. The Roman Catholic Church teaches seven sacraments, baptism, confirmation, Eucharist, penance, anointing of the sick, marriage, and holy orders, and confesses that they confer the grace they signify. The Eastern Orthodox tradition holds the same seven mysteries and frames them as the church's primary means of communion with God, with the Eucharist as the sacrament of sacraments. The Lutheran Augsburg Confession Article V states that through the Word and Sacraments as through instruments the Holy Spirit is given who works faith. The Anglican Article XXV calls the sacraments effectual signs of grace by which God works invisibly in us. The Reformed Westminster Confession affirms baptism and the Lord's Supper as ordinances of God by which grace is offered and conferred to such as that grace belongeth unto. The Methodist Articles, following Wesley, retain the two dominical sacraments and Wesley taught instituted means (prayer, scripture, the Lord's Supper, fasting, Christian conference) and prudential means (works of mercy and holy living). Pentecostals like the Assemblies of God confess water baptism and the Lord's Supper as ordinances and add the centrality of word, prayer, and Spirit-experience. Baptists, Plymouth Brethren, and most non-denominational bodies use ordinance rather than sacrament language and treat baptism and the breaking of bread as appointed commands rather than as conferring grace by the rite itself. The Quaker or Friends tradition is the historic public-record dissent from outward sacraments, practicing neither water baptism nor an outward Lord's Supper and treating the inward light of Christ as the sufficient means. The Salvation Army similarly omits outward sacraments. These Quaker and Salvationist positions are recognized as orthodox Christian dissents within historic Christianity, not as cult denials. The cult-grade boundary on this question is not crossed by reducing or expanding the count of sacraments; it would be crossed only by a system that denies the work of Christ and the Spirit to which the means point.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	No
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	Yes
Would participate if otherwise	Yes
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	Yes
Would marry if held otherwise	Yes
Would publicly correct if otherwise	No

Notes

The general doctrine that God uses ordained means (word, prayer, baptism, the Lord's Supper, fellowship) to convey grace is universally affirmed across the Christian world. The fierce disagreements are over the count and the mechanism. Catholics and Eastern Orthodox confess seven sacraments (baptism, confirmation or chrismation, Eucharist, penance, anointing of the sick, marriage, holy orders) and teach grace conferred *ex opere operato*. Lutherans, Anglicans, Reformed, and Methodists confess two dominical sacraments (baptism and the Lord's Supper) as effectual signs working invisibly. Baptists, Brethren, and most non-denominational bodies use the language of ordinances rather than sacraments, treating baptism and the Lord's Supper as appointed commands of Christ that convey grace through faith but not by the rite

as such. Pentecostals and most evangelicals retain the two ordinances and add the centrality of word and prayer. Wesley taught instituted means (prayer, searching the scriptures, the Lord's Supper, fasting, Christian conference) and prudential means (works of mercy, particular rules of holy living). The Quaker tradition is the historic public-record carrier of a near-total rejection of outward means, holding that the inward light of Christ is the primary and sufficient means; Quakers practice neither water baptism nor the outward Lord's Supper. The Salvation Army likewise omits outward sacraments. These are the only major bodies that approach denial of the general doctrine; even they affirm direct communion with God as a means, so the denial is partial. Children can safely be taught the general means-of-grace doctrine in any orthodox tradition; the specific sacramentology one's family will inherit is a downstream choice. Public-record cult-grade denials of means as such are not catalogued in this question; the relevant cult markers (denial of the Trinity, denial of bodily resurrection, denial of Christ's deity) are answered elsewhere.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, dispensationalism, new_covenant_theology, progressive_covenantalism

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

sacramental-catholic-orthodox-lutheran-anglican · **for**: Reads the means of grace as effectual signs that confer the grace they signify. Baptism regenerates, the Eucharist communicates the body and blood of Christ, confession absolves. Word and sacrament are paired channels of the Spirit's work. The Catholic and Orthodox traditions extend the count to seven, the Lutheran and Anglican traditions retain the two dominical sacraments while teaching them as effectual.

reformed-confessional · **for**: Reads the means of grace as ordinances of God in which grace is offered and conferred to such as that grace belongeth unto. Word, sacraments, and prayer are the appointed instruments. The Westminster Shorter Catechism Q88 names these three explicitly. Baptism and the Lord's Supper are signs and seals, not bare memorials, but their efficacy is by the Spirit working through them in conjunction with faith.

evangelical-brethren-baptist-ordinance · **for**: Reads baptism and the breaking of bread as ordinances commanded by Christ, observed in obedience and faith. Grace is communicated through the word preached, prayer, and the Spirit's work in the fellowship. The rite itself does not convey grace mechanically; the heart of faith receives grace as the means are practiced. Means are real channels but not causes.

wesleyan-methodist · **for**: Wesley distinguished instituted means (prayer, scripture, the Lord's Supper, fasting, Christian conference) from prudential means (works of mercy and particular rules of holy living). Both kinds are channels through which the Spirit conveys grace to believers in their pursuit of holiness.

pentecostal-charismatic · **for**: Retains the two ordinances and adds central emphasis on Spirit-baptism, prophecy, gifts of healing, and direct Spirit-experience as means of grace alongside word and prayer. Some streams add the laying on of hands as a regular channel of healing and Spirit-gifting.

quaker-friends-spiritualist · **complicates**: Holds that the inward light of Christ is the primary and sufficient means of grace. Rejects outward water baptism and the outward Lord's Supper as no longer required under the new covenant. Treats silent waiting and direct communion with the Spirit as the appointed means. This is the historic public-record minority position within Christianity that comes closest to denying the general doctrine. Even Quakers affirm direct Spirit-communion as a means, so the denial is partial, not total.

The general doctrine that God uses ordained means is pan-canonically demonstrated and confessed across nearly every Christian lineage. The dispute is taxonomic and mechanical: which means count, how many, and whether they confer grace ex opere operato or in conjunction with faith. The Brethren-Reformed-Baptist ordinance language and the Catholic-Orthodox sevenfold sacramental system represent the two ends of a spectrum. Analogia scripturae is heavily invoked: the dominical commands (Matt 28:19 baptism, 1 Cor 11:24-25 Supper), the prayer commands (Luke 11:13, James 5:13-16), the word commands (Rom 10:17, 1 Tim 4:13, 2 Tim 3:16), and the fellowship commands (Heb 10:24-25, Acts 2:42) cohere as a network. Progressive revelation factor: Ezek 36:25-27 anticipates the New Covenant pattern of water-and-Spirit means that the New Testament fulfills.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Rom.10.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πίστις pistis G4102 (faith); ἀκοή akoe G189 (hearing, report); ῥῆμα rhema G4487 (spoken word); Χριστός Christos G5547

Force. So faith comes from hearing, and hearing through the word of Christ. The spoken word of Christ is named as the instrumental means through which faith is given. The grammar places akoe as the channel and rhema Christou as the content. The word preached is the appointed means of faith.

1Cor.11.23-26 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metonymy

Key term. ἄρτος artos G740 (bread); ποτήριον poterion G4221 (cup); ἀνάμνησις anamnesis G364 (remembrance); ποιέω poieo G4160 (do); καταγγέλλω kataggello G2605 (proclaim)

Force. Paul transmits the Lord's institution of the Supper. The bread broken and cup shared are commanded by Christ himself, to be done in remembrance of him, and the act proclaims the Lord's death until he comes. The Supper is named as a divinely instituted ongoing means of the church's life.

Matt.28.19 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. μαθητεύω matheteuo G3100 (make disciples, aorist imperative); βαπτίζω baptizo G907 (baptizing, present participle); ὄνομα onoma G3686 (name)

Force. Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit. Baptism is named as part of the dominical commission. The participle baptizontes attaches the rite directly to the disciple-making act as one of the appointed instruments of the church's mission.

Acts.2.42 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. προσκαρτερέω proskartereo G4342 (devote themselves, present active participle); διδασκία didache G1322 (teaching); κοινωνία koinonia G2842 (fellowship); κλάσις klasis G2800 (breaking); ἄρτος artos G740 (bread); προσευχή proseuche G4335 (prayer)

Force. And they were devoting themselves to the apostles' teaching and the fellowship, to the breaking of bread and the prayers. Luke names four ordained practices as the constitutive devotion of the church. The participle proskarterountes describes ongoing devotion. The four nouns each take the article in Greek, marking them as the defined practices of the apostolic church.

Eph.5.26 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. ἁγιάζω hagiazo G37 (sanctify); καθαρίζω katharizo G2511 (cleanse); λουτρόν loutron G3067 (washing, bath); ὕδωρ hudor G5204 (water); ῥῆμα rhema G4487 (word)

Force. Christ loved the church and gave himself for her, that he might sanctify her, having cleansed her by the washing of water with the word. The cleansing instrument is the loutron tou hudatos en rhemati. Water and word together are named as Christ's means of cleansing the church. Whether the loutron is read as baptism with the word preached over it (the patristic and Lutheran reading) or as the cleansing the word effects through faith (the Reformed-evangelical reading), the verse names a specific means.

1Tim.4.4-5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἁγιάζω hagiazo G37 (sanctify, present passive); λόγος logos G3056 (word); θεός theos G2316 (God); ἑντευξις enteuxis G1783 (prayer, intercession)

Force. Everything created by God is good, and nothing is to be rejected if received with thanksgiving, for it is made holy by the word of God and prayer. Word and prayer are named together as the means by which received gifts are sanctified for the believer's use. The grammar treats the two together as the instrumental cause of sanctification.

Luke.11.9-13 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. αἰτέω aiteo G154 (ask); ζητέω zeteo G2212 (seek); κρούω krouo G2925 (knock); δίδωμι didomi G1325 (give); πνεῦμα ἅγιον pneuma hagon G4151 G40 (Holy Spirit)

Force. Ask and it will be given to you, seek and you will find, knock and it will be opened to you. If you then being evil know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will the heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask him. Prayer is named as the appointed means through which the Father gives the Holy Spirit. The present-tense imperatives mark this as continuing practice.

Tit.3.5 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. σῶζω sozo G4982 (saved); λουτρόν loutron G3067 (washing); παλιγγενεσία paliggenesia G3824 (regeneration, rebirth); ἀνακαίνωσις anakainosis G342 (renewal); πνεῦμα ἅγιον pneuma hagon G4151 G40

Force. He saved us by the washing of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Spirit. The same word loutron used in Eph 5:26 reappears, here paired with regeneration and Spirit-renewal. The means and the effect are bound together in one phrase. Reading this with Eph 5:26 anchors washing as a named instrument of saving grace.

John.6.53-56 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key term. τρώγω trogo G5176 (eat, chew); πίνω pino G4095 (drink); σὰρξ sarx G4561 (flesh); αἷμα haima G129 (blood); ζωή zoe G2222 (life); μένω meno G3306 (abide)

Force. Truly, truly I say to you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood you have no life in yourselves. Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood abides in me and I in him. Jesus's discourse links eating and drinking him to the believer's life and abiding in him. Catholics, Orthodox, Lutherans, and Anglicans read this with strong eucharistic force; Reformed and Brethren read it primarily as faith-language with eucharistic resonance. Either way it names ingestion as a figure of the means by which Christ's life is communicated.

Heb.10.24-25 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. παροξυσμός paroxusmos G3948 (stir up); ἀγάπη agape G26 (love); ἔργον ergon G2041 (works); ἐπισυναγωγή episunagoge G1997 (gathering together); παρακαλέω parakaleo G3870 (encourage)

Force. Let us consider how to stir up one another to love and good works, not neglecting to meet together as is the habit of some, but encouraging one another. The gathered assembly of believers is named as the means through which mutual stirring up to love and good works happens. Christian fellowship is treated as an appointed instrument of perseverance.

1Tim.4.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀνάγνωσις anagnosis G320 (reading, public); παράκλησις paraklesis G3874 (exhortation); διδασκαλία didaskalia G1319 (teaching)

Force. Until I come, devote yourself to the public reading of Scripture, to exhortation, to teaching. Paul charges Timothy with three public ministries of the word. Public Scripture reading, exhortation, and teaching are named as the ordained office-bearer's ongoing means of building the church.

James.5.13-16 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. προσεύχομαι proseuchomai G4336 (pray); ψάλλω psallo G5567 (sing praise); χρίω chrio G218 (anoint); ἔλαιον elaion G1637 (oil); ἑξομολογέω exomologeō G1843 (confess)

Force. Is anyone among you suffering? Let him pray. Is anyone cheerful? Let him sing praise. Is anyone among you sick? Let him call for the elders of the church, and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord. Confess your sins to one another and pray for one another. Prayer, song, anointing, confession, mutual prayer are named as appointed church-ordained practices through which the suffering are restored and healing is given.

Acts.8.13-23 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key term. βαπτίζω baptizo G907; πικρία pikria G4088 (bitterness); χολή chole G5521 (gall); καρδιά kardia G2588 (heart)

Force. Simon himself believed and was baptized. Yet Peter says to him, your heart is not right before God, for I see that you are in the gall of bitterness and in the bond of iniquity. A man can receive the outward rite without the inward grace. The means do not operate as mechanical guarantees apart from faith. This complicates any view that treats the rite as automatic conveyance.

Isa.1.11-17 · complicates · genre: prophecy

Key term. זֶבַח zebach H2077 (sacrifice); עֹלָה olah H5930 (burnt offering); מִנְחָה minchah H4503 (grain offering); תְּפִלָּה tephillah H8605 (prayer)

Force. What to me is the multitude of your sacrifices? Says the LORD. When you spread out your hands I will hide my eyes from you, even though you make many prayers I will not listen. The appointed means of the old covenant become abhorrent to God when severed from righteousness and obedience. The means do not coerce God to give grace when the heart is in rebellion.

John.4.23-24 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. ἀληθινός alethinos G228 (true); προσκυνητής proskunetes G4353 (worshiper); πνεῦμα pneuma G4151 (spirit); ἀλήθεια aletheia G225 (truth)

Force. The hour is coming and is now here, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth. Jesus locates worship in spirit and truth rather than in a place or rite as such. This text is the standard Quaker citation for downgrading outward means. Yet read in context it does not abolish baptism or the Supper, it relativizes location and rite to inward reality.

1Pet.3.21 · for · genre: epistle · figures: typology

Key term. ἀντίτυπος antitypos G499 (corresponding); βάπτισμα baptism G908 (baptism); σῶζω sozo G4982 (save); συνείδησις suneidesis G4893 (conscience); ἀνάστασις anastasis G386 (resurrection)

Force. Baptism, which corresponds to this, now saves you, not as a removal of dirt from the body but as an appeal to God for a good conscience, through the resurrection of Jesus Christ. Peter names baptism as saving while immediately defining the manner: not the outward washing but the appeal to God through Christ's resurrection. The verse holds the means together with its proper inward correlate.

Ezek.36.25-27 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: metaphor

Key term. זָרַק zaraq H2236 (sprinkle); מַיִם mayim H4325 (water); טָהוֹר tahor H2889 (clean); רוּחַ ruach H7307 (Spirit); לֵב lev H3820 (heart)

Force. I will sprinkle clean water on you, and you shall be clean. I will put my Spirit within you. The Old Testament promise of New Covenant cleansing names water-sprinkling and Spirit-giving as paired means through which the covenant people are made new. The pattern of means and Spirit appears already in the prophets.

Acts.20.32 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. παρατίθημι paratithemi G3908 (commit, entrust); λόγος χάριτος logos charitos G3056 G5485 (word of grace); οἰκοδομέω oikodomeo G3618 (build up); κληρονομία kleronomia G2817 (inheritance)

Force. And now I commend you to God and to the word of his grace, which is able to build you up and to give you the inheritance among all those who are sanctified. Paul names the word of grace as the means with the inherent power to build up believers and secure their inheritance.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G4102, G189, G4487, G5547, G740, G4221, G364, G4160, G2605, G3100, G907, G908, G3686, G4342, G1322, G2842, G2800, G4335, G4336, G37, G2511, G3067, G5204, G3056, G2316, G1783, G154, G2212, G2925, G1325, G4151, G40, G4982, G3824, G342, G5176, G4095, G4561, G129, G2222, G3306, G3948, G26, G2041, G1997, G3870, G320, G3874, G1319, G5567, G218, G1637, G1843, G4088, G5521, G2588, G499, G4893, G386, G228, G4353, G225, G3908, G5485, G3618, G2817, H2077, H5930, H4503, H8605, H2236, H4325, H2889, H7307, H3820

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Justin Martyr, First Apology, chapters 65-66 (mid-second century), CCEL ANF Vol 1 · **affirms · **unverified****

“The food which is blessed by the prayer of His word, and from which our blood and flesh by transmutation are nourished, is the flesh and blood of that Jesus who was made flesh. The Eucharist is treated as a real means of grace.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church, paragraphs 1113-1131 (The Sacramental Economy) · **affirms · **unverified****

“The whole liturgical life of the Church revolves around the Eucharistic sacrifice and the sacraments. There are seven sacraments in the Church. The sacraments confer the grace that they signify.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America, The Orthodox Faith Vol II, On the Holy Eucharist, oca.org · **affirms · **verified****

“The eucharist in the Orthodox Church is understood to be the genuine Body and Blood of Christ precisely because bread and wine are the mysteries and symbols of God’s true and genuine presence and manifestation to us in Christ.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession (1530), Article V (Of the Ministry) and Article XIII (Of the Use of the Sacraments), bookofconcord.org · **affirms · **verified****

“Through the Word and Sacraments, as through instruments, the Holy Ghost is given, who works faith; where and when it pleases God, in them that hear the Gospel.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion (1571), Article XXV (Of the Sacraments) · **affirms · **unverified****

“Sacraments ordained of Christ are not only badges or tokens of Christian men’s profession, but rather they are certain sure witnesses and effectual signs of grace, by which God doth work invisibly in us.”

reformed · Westminster Shorter Catechism (1647), Question 88 (Outward Means of Salvation) · **affirms · **unverified****

“The outward and ordinary means whereby Christ communicates to us the benefits of redemption are his ordinances, especially the Word, sacraments, and prayer; all which are made effectual to the elect for salvation.”

methodist · **Methodist Articles of Religion, Article XVI (Of the Sacraments), umc.org** · **affirms** · **verified**

“Sacraments ordained of Christ are not only badges or tokens of Christian men's profession, but rather they are certain signs of grace, and God's good will toward us, by which he doth work invisibly in us.”

anabaptist · **Schleitheim Confession (1527), Articles I (Concerning Baptism) and III (Concerning the Breaking of Bread)** · **affirms** · **unverified**

“Baptism shall be given to all those who have learned repentance and amendment of life. All who wish to break the one bread in remembrance of the broken body of Christ shall be united beforehand by baptism in one body of Christ.”

pentecostal · **Assemblies of God, Statement of Fundamental Truths, Articles 6 (Ordinances of the Church): Water Baptism and the Lord's Supper** · **affirms** · **unverified**

“The ordinance of baptism by immersion is commanded in the Scriptures. The Lord's Supper, consisting of the elements, bread and the fruit of the vine, is a symbol expressing our sharing the divine nature.”

continuationist · **Quaker tradition, Robert Barclay's Apology for the True Christian Divinity (1678), Propositions XII-XIII (On Baptism and the Supper)** · **denies** · **unverified**

“The baptism of Christ is one inward spiritual baptism, not the washing of water. The communion of the body and blood of Christ is inward and spiritual, the supper of the Lamb is the soul's feeding upon Christ within.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/10-17.htm>

“Rom 10:17: ara he pistis ex akoes, he de akoe dia rhematos Christou. Faith from hearing, hearing through the spoken word of Christ. Word named as instrumental means of faith.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/2-42.htm>

“Acts 2:42: esan de proskarterountes te didache ton apostolon kai te koinonia, te klasei tou artou kai tais proseuchais. Four practices, each articular, as the constitutive devotion of the apostolic church.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/matthew/28-19.htm>

“Matt 28:19: poreuthentes oun matheteusate panta ta ethne, baptizontes autous eis to onoma. Baptizing is a participle attached to the disciple-making imperative.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/5-26.htm>

“Eph 5:26: hina auten hagiase katharisas to loutro tou hudatos en rhemati. Christ sanctifies the church having cleansed her by the washing of water with the word.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_timothy/4-5.htm

“1 Tim 4:5: hagiazetai gar dia logou Theou kai enteuxeos. It is sanctified by the word of God and prayer. Word and prayer as paired instrumental means of sanctification.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/luke/11-13.htm>

“Luke 11:13: poso mallon ho Pater ho ex ouranou dosei Pneuma Hagion tois aitousin auton. How much more will the heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask. Prayer as means of Spirit-giving.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/3067.htm>

“Loutron G3067, a bath or washing. Two NT occurrences: Eph 5:26 (washing of water with the word) and Tit 3:5 (washing of regeneration). Both link washing to means of cleansing.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/11-26.htm

“1 Cor 11:26: hosakis gar ean esthiete ton arton touton kai to poterion pinete, ton thanaton tou Kyriou katagellete achri hou elthe. The Supper proclaims the Lord's death until he comes.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/>

“Augsburg V: Through the Word and Sacraments, as through instruments, the Holy Ghost is given, who works faith where and when it pleases God in them that hear the Gospel.”

supports · category: tradition_primary ·

<https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith/worship/the-sacraments/holy-eucharist>

“OCA on the Eucharist: the genuine Body and Blood of Christ, the mysteries and symbols of God's true presence and manifestation to us in Christ. Means of grace through real participation.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article XVI: Sacraments ordained of Christ are certain signs of grace, and God's good will toward us, by which he doth work invisibly in us, and doth quicken, strengthen, and confirm our faith.”

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